Tutorial Composition and Idioms

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1. Consider the following English phrases:

   (a) walk quickly
   (b) spill the tea
   (c) green thumb
   (d) write an email
   (e) night sky
   (f) break the ice

   Which ones have a non-compositional reading, and what is it?
   e.g. *hit the sack* — non-compositional: "go to bed";
   hit the nail — compositional

2. Give an example of a multiword expression meaning the following in a language you speak.

   (1) become angry
   (2) die
   (3) get up early
   (4) do two things at once
   (5) rain heavily

3. Classify following Czech idioms as

   (a) Fixed Expression
   (b) Semi-Fixed Expression
   (c) Decomposable Expression
   (d) Non-decomposable Expression
   (e) Institutionalized Phrases

   (6) *házet klacky pod nohy* "throw sticks under feet'
   (7) *mít máslo na hlavě* "have butter on head"
   (8) *vzít roha* "run away"
   (9) *tak říkajíc* "so to speak"
   (10) *sůl a pepř* "salt and pepper"
   (11) *zuby nehty* "tooth and nail"
   (12) *ztratit hlavu* "lose head"
   (13) *otevřít někomu oči* "open someone's eyes"
   (14) *v průběhu* "in progress" (during)
   (15) *na koleně* "on knee" (improvised)

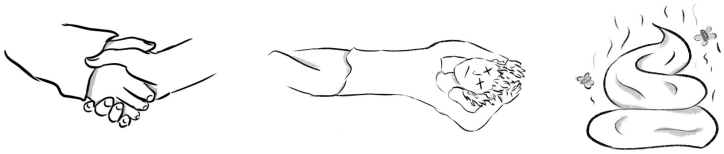
4. Enjoy the following example: (thanks to Jindra Rehak)

<u>Petr se vsadil, že natáhne brka na stolici.</u>

Peter made a bet he would stretch feathers on a stool.

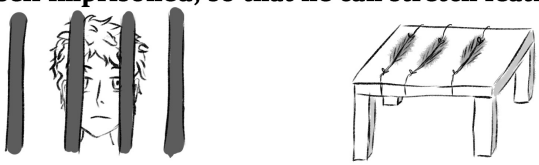
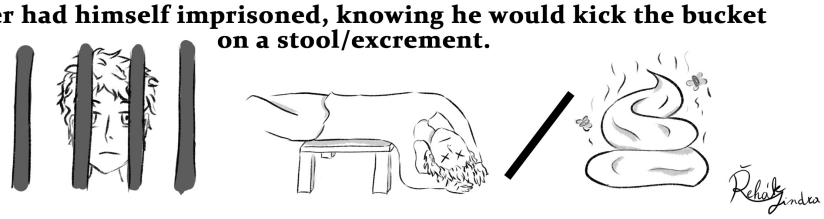
Peter made a bet he would kick the bucket on a stool.

Peter made a bet he would kick the bucket on an excrement.



Peter planted himself, because he wanted to stretch feathers on a stool.

Peter had himself imprisoned, so that he can stretch feathers on a stool.



Peter had himself imprisoned, knowing he would kick the bucket on a stool/excrement.